

ELENA ROUSSOU

Senior Backend Engineer - Athens, Greece

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 7 years building and operating Python services for high-traffic consumer products. Comfortable owning a service end to end, from schema design through to on-call. Most recent work has been on payments and order processing.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer, Nexora Commerce (2021 - 2024)

Owned the order processing service handling 1.2M orders per month.

Rebuilt the checkout API in Python and FastAPI, replacing a legacy Flask service; reduced p99 latency from 840ms to 210ms by moving to async I/O and adding connection pooling.

Designed the PostgreSQL schema for the orders domain, including partitioning by month once the table passed 400M rows, and wrote the migration playbook the team still uses.

Introduced RabbitMQ for order events so that fulfilment and invoicing could be decoupled from checkout; this cut checkout timeouts by 90 percent.

Mentored two junior engineers through their first year, running weekly code review sessions and pairing on their first production changes.

Raised test coverage on the payments module from 34 percent to 81 percent using pytest, and made the suite a required check before merge.

Backend Engineer, Delphi Analytics (2018 - 2021)

Built REST APIs in Python and Django for a B2B analytics dashboard used by around 300 customer accounts.

Containerised the application with Docker and wrote the first CI pipeline in GitHub Actions, taking deploys from a manual weekly release to daily automated deploys.

Deployed and maintained services on AWS using EC2, S3 and RDS. Set up CloudWatch dashboards and alerts for the ingestion pipeline.

Wrote the internal API style guide adopted across three teams.

Junior Developer, Ionian Software (2017 - 2018)

Maintained a PHP monolith and wrote the reporting module that replaced a set of manual spreadsheets.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science, Athens University of Economics and Business, 2017

BSc Informatics, University of Piraeus, 2015

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, JavaScript, PHP

Frameworks: FastAPI, Django, Flask, pytest

Data: PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ

Infrastructure: Docker, AWS (EC2, S3, RDS), GitHub Actions, Linux

Practices: REST API design, code review, pair programming, agile delivery